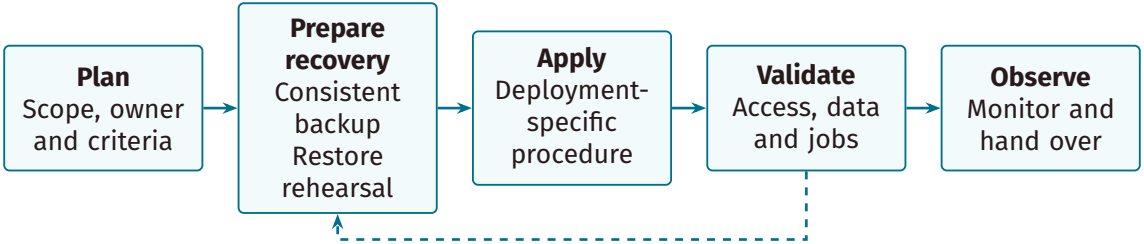
Plan
Scope, owner and criteria
Prepare recovery
Consistent backup
Restore rehearsal
Apply
Deployment-specific procedure
Validate
Access, data and jobs
Observe
Monitor and hand over
If acceptance fails: stop, assess and use the rehearsed recovery plan. Database changes can make a simple code downgrade unsafe.